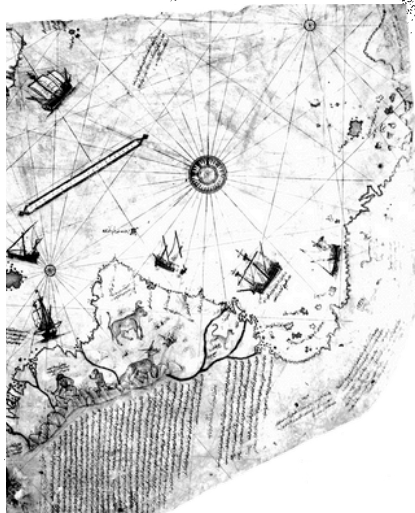


SNZ #CLASSIFIEDS



**You're
special**



a surviving fragment of a world
map by Ottoman admiral and
cartographer Piri Reis, 1513.



TURTLE

is a fun guessing
game.

turtlewordgame.xyz

Play for free once a
day, or pay with
lightning for as
many games as you
like. Unlike similar
games, none of your
data is collected by
a legacy media
company.

SNZ #CLASSIFIEDS



a weekly zine

Issue #41
Jan 2 - Jan 9



931 593

\$91065

s Meyer

duced WITHOUT
tudents, librarians,

SNZ is a collection of the
top posts from Stacker
News this week - plus other fun stuff.
Made every week in ATX!

find more at
plebpoet.com/zines.html

Note from the Editor

Greetings to you!
and a happy new year!

Have you had premonitions of
global conflict, hyper-inflation,
dishonest thugs in suits,
and attention take-over?

Have you given over the
control of your feelings
to the timeline which
wishes to extract
your life away from
you?

Or do you have any
other awesome plans?

I'm neutral on most of
this which I refer to.
Pretty neutral on everything,
as a matter of fact.

or have I forgotten how to feel?

WITH
THANKS
TO
@KODD

the machine wants your life

will you take up the sword?

Bonnie and Clyde Music Video

top
boost

by Richard Greaser



400 sats \ 10k boost \ 1 comment \ @thebitcoinbugle 8 Jan Music

This video follows Kailey Welch, the producer
of the Bugle Weekly and journalist, as she
fantasizes about her boyfriend eCash \$aylor,
the aspiring Bugleverse
rapper.

In her fantasy she sees herself and eCash
as two outlaws in love similar to Bonnie
Parker and Clyde Barrow, living in an
adversarial world that hates them for
who they are. She believes that instead of submitting to the world around her,
she wants them to fight it even if destroys them.
Please check it out and share!

BONNIE AND CLYDE





Situation in Venezuela, January 3, 2026

14.7k sats \ 107 comments \ @bief57
3 Jan Politics_And_Law

The atmosphere is tense, with many feeling both hopeful and fearful. Markets and pharmacies are packed, seas of people stocking up.

Photos and videos taken from the Internet

< In Catia Square and the Catia Market, west of Caracas, shops are selling products with their shutters down. There are more shops open than in the surrounding neighborhoods, where there are barely two or three shops open per street.

Some people are buying in bulk. The dollar is being sold for between 500 and 600 bolivars.

from X

Apparently, Nicolás Maduro was indeed captured, according to statements from Trump. So far, there are no real photos of Maduro and his wife in US custody, although one image is circulating in the media, but it appears to be AI-generated.

This is the statement from Maria Corina Machado:



in case you are like me and
you didn't know Maria Corina Machado

< Venezuelans, the HOUR OF FREEDOM HAS ARRIVED!

Nicolás Maduro, starting today, faces international justice for the atrocious crimes committed against Venezuelans and against citizens of many other nations. Given his refusal to accept a negotiated solution, the United States government has fulfilled its promise to uphold the law.

The time has come for Popular Sovereignty and National Sovereignty to govern our country. We will restore order, free the political prisoners, build an exceptional country, and bring our children back home.

We have fought for years, we have given everything, and it has been worth it. What had to happen is happening.

This is the hour of the citizens. Those of us who risked everything for democracy on July 28th. Those of us who elected Edmundo González Urrutia as the legitimate President of Venezuela, who must immediately assume his constitutional mandate and be recognized as Commander-in-Chief of the National Armed Forces by all the officers and soldiers who comprise it

Today we are prepared to assert our mandate and take power. Let us remain vigilant, active, and organized until the Democratic Transition is realized. A transition that needs ALL of us.

To Venezuelans inside our country, be ready to implement what we will soon communicate to you through our official channels.

To Venezuelans abroad, we need you mobilized, activating the governments and citizens of the world and engaging them now in the great operation of building the new Venezuela.

In these decisive hours, receive all my strength, my confidence, and my affection. We all remain alert and in contact.

VENEZUELA WILL BE FREE!

We go hand in hand with God, until the end.

Maria Corina Machado January 3, 2026

The presidency legitimately belongs to Edmundo Gonzalez, as he won the 2024 elections, which were marred by electoral fraud. However, he fled Venezuela that same year with the permission of those in power. Maria Corina Machado is also out of the country; her escape was reportedly a story worthy of a novel (the most dramatic imaginable). < continued next page >



Venezuelanos,
Llegó la HORA DE LA LIBERTAD!

Nicolás Maduro desde hoy enfrenta la justicia internacional por los crímenes atroces cometidos contra los venezolanos y contra ciudadanos de muchas otras naciones. Ante su negativa a aceptar una salida negociada, el gobierno de los Estados Unidos ha cumplido su promesa de hacer valer la ley.

Llegó la hora de que la Soberanía Popular y la Soberanía Nacional rijan en nuestro país. Vamos a poner orden, liberar a los presos políticos, construir un país excepcional y traer a nuestros hijos de vuelta a casa.

Hemos luchado por años, lo hemos entregado todo, y ha valido la pena. Lo que tenía que pasar está pasando.

Esta es la hora de los ciudadanos. Los que arriesgamos todo por la democracia el 28 de julio. Los que elegimos a Edmundo González Urrutia como legítimo Presidente de Venezuela, quien debe asumir de inmediato su mandato constitucional y ser reconocido como Comandante en Jefe de la Fuerza Armada Nacional por todos los oficiales y soldados que la integran.

Hoy estamos preparados para hacer valer nuestro mandato y tomar el poder. Permanecemos vigilantes, activos y organizados hasta que se concrete la Transición Democrática. Una transición que nos necesita a TODOS.

A los venezolanos que están dentro de nuestro país, están listos para poner en marcha lo que muy pronto les vamos a comunicar a través de nuestros canales oficiales.

A los venezolanos que están en el exterior, los necesitamos movilizados, activando a los gobiernos y ciudadanos del mundo y comprometiéndolos desde ya a la gran operación de construcción de la nueva Venezuela.

En estas horas decisivas, reciban toda mi fuerza, mi confianza y mi cariño. Seguimos todos alertas y en contacto.

VENEZUELA SERÁ LIBRE!

Vamos de la mano de Dios, hasta el final.

Maria Corina Machado

03 de enero del 2026



This leaves Venezuela without any opposition leaders within its borders. From this perspective, the situation looks bleak.

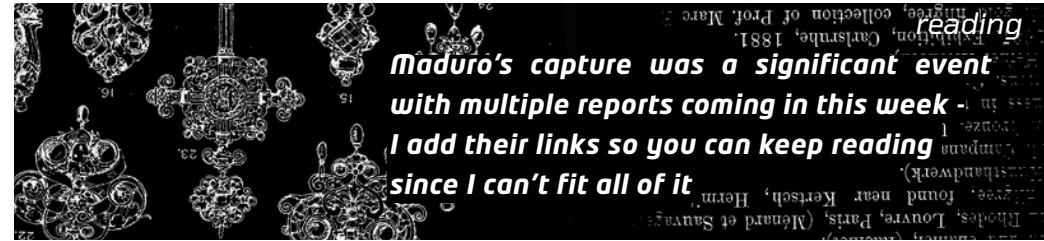
The vice president appointed by Nicolás Maduro is Delcy Rodríguez (It is speculated that he is in Moscow), which means that in his absence, for Chavismo, she would be the new "leader".

It doesn't matter that Maduro and his wife have been taken away because the Rodríguez brothers (Jorge Rodríguez and Delcy Rodríguez) Padrino Lopez, and Diosdado Cabello are still free in Venezuela. They are extremely important figures, they are the regime.

There's a lot of speculation. Did they betray Maduro? Is that why there was no defense of what happened this morning? Or did Maduro negotiate and surrender? And was that little "bombing" just a show?

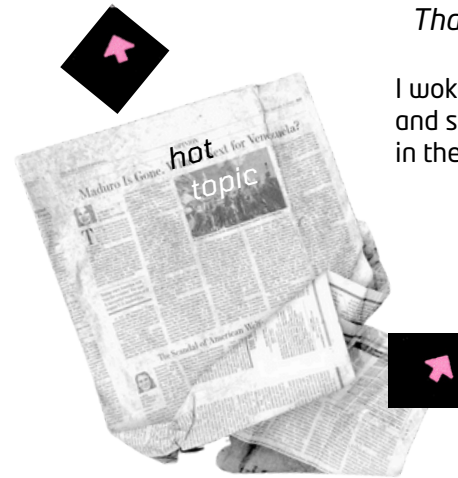
There are more questions than answers. The only certainty so far is that ordinary citizens are in danger. On one hand, armed groups are threatening anyone who celebrates Maduro's capture. Riots could break out; right now, there's no law that matters. Another possible scenario is that we'll be cornered and have basic services completely cut off, leaving markets closed and empty for a long time. I'm just outlining the worst-case scenarios. The reality right now is that everyone is sheltering at home, some are getting food, but everything is relatively calm; there's no chaos in the streets, apart from people looking for supplies.

A brief summary so far. I'll continue updating later.



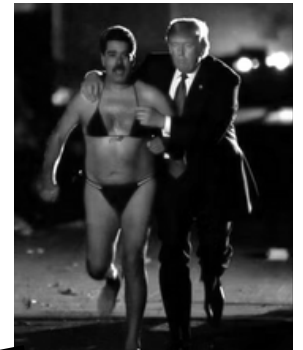
Blindly trusting the government kept me from being tricked by AI

1577 sats \ 1234 boost \ 49 comments \ @Scoresby 3 Jan AI



That fake photo of Maduro getting captured

I woke up this morning and saw this photo in the news:



Obviously fake, right?



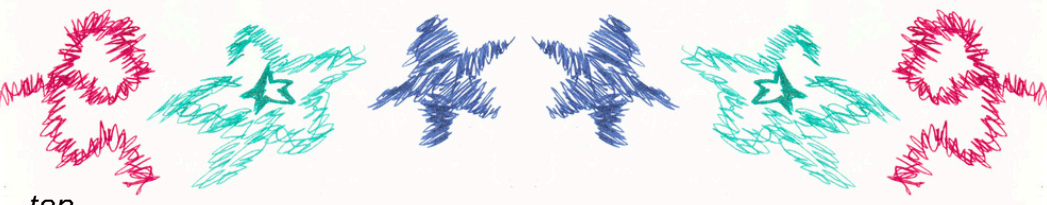
Situation in Venezuela, January 6, 2026

12k sats \ 50 comments \ @bief57 6 Jan Politics_And_Law

This should be a sensitive topic, but instead it's seemed more like a comedy show. Unfortunately.

I say this with irony and regret. I'm referring especially to how this has been viewed from abroad, and even worse, on social media and other forms of communication.

The feeling among people inside Venezuela is fear, yes, fear. They updated the official gazette and added new articles, one of which states that anyone who celebrates what happened on January 3rd can be imprisoned. There are operations underway in different parts of the country where armed individuals are checking people's phones. This is seen more frequently and intensely in Caracas.



top
post

Why don't you like slop?

1690 sats \ 333 boost \ 22 comments \ @k00b 4 Jan AI AskSN



I want to come up with a better answer to this because I struggle to articulate one, and I know my feelings are right, right?

I'd like focus on slop absent other norm defying things, trying to isolate slop from plagiarism and greater intent crimes. Obviously people copy and pasting slop as their own thoughts are dishonest and worthy of resentment.

So why don't we like slop that's known, by label or otherwise, to be slop? And why don't we like "slop" that's an elaboration of some prompt or human written text?

I'd also like us to assume the slop in question is qualitatively on par with content that would exist in its absence. Obviously bad content is bad. Personally, I believe I wouldn't like the good slop either. Or, at least, I don't want to value it like I would comparable human content. But why?

One of my favored answers is that it's unclear what my role is in consuming or engaging with slop when it's shared in a human social environment. When I consume slop, who do I hold accountable for errors? Who do I praise for insight? What good does either do? Slop acts on me but I can't act on it. It's asymmetrical and that's generally antithetical to our goals when engaging in a human social environment. Engaging with slop is about as consequential as sending celebrity fan mail, and I don't do that, do you?

My second favored answer is that unless slop is crafted with great care, sharing slop is sharing a commodity. We can all prompt some free model somewhere on the internet now. Sharing slop is sharing something that's practically worthless. It's like getting Amazon Basics socks for Christmas vs those carefully knitted ones from your Aunt Rebecca. I can buy my own cheap socks, and in the color and ankle height that I want, Rebecca!

Why don't you like slop? Or, if you don't mind it, why not? Or, if you like slop, why do you like it?

top
comments

262 sats \ 0 replies \ @Aardvark 4 Jan

Because it's rude of you to ask me to spend more time reading something than it took you to write it.

It's asking me to put in effort when you couldn't be bothered to.

235 sats \ 5 replies \ @justin_shocknet 4 Jan

I think because there's grades of slop, and it's an investment to decipher good slop from bad slop.

You can identify shitty writing right off the bat, and move on to the next tab. But with slop, it's always a consistent cadence and formatting, so it takes a little more time to discern the substance. The result of a lazy prompt looks the same as a well-deliberated iterative prompt at first glance.

Slop is good when its used as a tool for formatting and making readable first-hand knowledge and putting support around it. Slop is bad when its used by someone that never would never have written a thing in the first place as they had no real thoughts of their own.

Slop version for the slop inclined:
Modernity vomits a gray uniformity, a democratic leveling where the noble thought and the plebeian reflex wear the same mask. This consistent cadence—this rhythmic, mechanical pulse—is the ultimate deception of the Last Man. He no longer needs to possess a soul; he only needs a prompt....

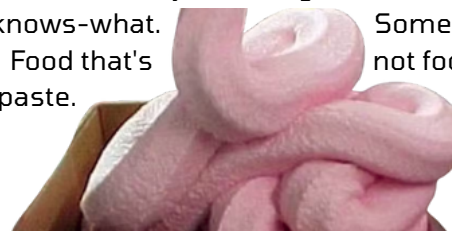
248 sats \ 0 replies \ @Aeneas 4 Jan

I think we can listen to the voice of the people on this one, as they're surprisingly adept at adopting good metaphors. The word "Slop" itself tells us a lot. It conjures images like *animal feed*, or gross stews full of God-knows-what. Some unappealing gruel.

Food that's not food; food mashed up and made into a paste.

"Pink slime" instead of beef.

(From the McDonald's 'pink slime' era)



It all points to something that doesn't nourish you, even if it's slapped

together to look and sound like real food.

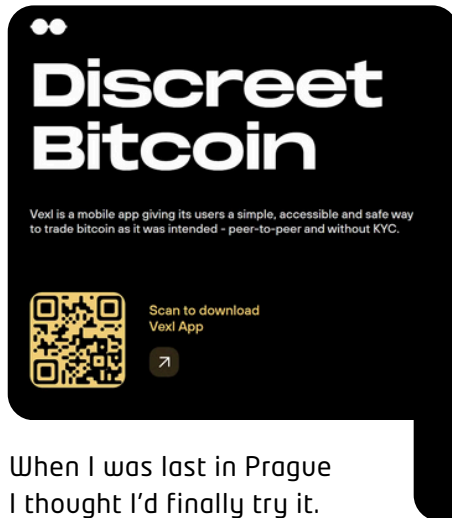
p.s. I do think slop is permissible in memes; they have always been low effort slop to begin with.



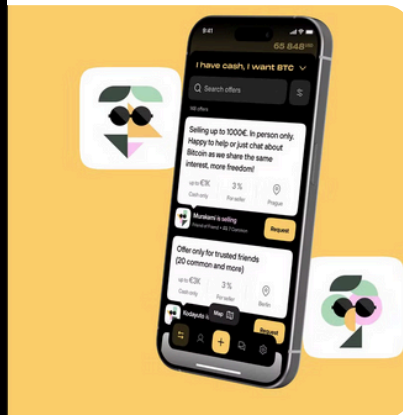
On the Economics of Peer-to-Peer: I Tried Vexl

7671 sats \ 13 comments \ @denlillaapan 6 Jan econ

There's a cool European (Czech, really) app that's owned/run/bankrolled by the Trezor mafia in Prague: They're awesome, their merch and messaging is dope, and what they offer is a good old-fashioned anonymous marketplace, most for fiat-to-bitcoin (but really, anything can be traded there).



When I was last in Prague I thought I'd finally try it.



By definition, peer-to-peer is **economically inefficient**. Bitcoin as a messaging/money system is *also* inefficient but we do that for a reason, willing to trade off the expense and tech and speed to achieve other, higher ends. The big problem of peer-to-peer mechanism is that centralization is (economically) efficient.

With a middleman, a seller doesn't have to be online or processing the transaction at the same time as the buyer. We don't have to coordinate, but the middleman – against a cut and loss of sovereignty/independence, obviously – can spread out the transactions, literally match buyers and sellers by trading with them sequentially.

Plus, as is more obvious in terms of various fiat currencies moving across the world or banking systems settling daily, delayed net settlement is *efficient* in that you can just net out the difference rather than (ex)change every single unidirectional trade.

Peer-to-peer markets in Bitcoin, for various things or as non-KYC corn, have the same trouble. **The fact that they sort of kind of work right now is testimony to the extra length to which many hardcore Bitcoiners value their privacy (paranoia?)** or want to test out various arrangements, money-where-your-mouth-is, that aren't that common. *Be the change you want to see.*

So, I spun up the app, matched with some local Czech money drug-dealer, and arranged for a meet-up some 20 minutes away from where I was staying: great time for a morning jog.

Up I went, ran over to the rendezvous point... and waited.

Felt like a total drug dealer, meeting some random dude I don't know what he looks like or what his name is – the way it's supposed to feel?

A few minutes later he showed up, and I got something like 3,000 CZK (~150 dollars) in cash, in exchange for a quick Lightning transaction over to him.

No name, no traceable transaction, no centralized middleman.

That's cool. That's edgy.

Now, **the bad stuff:**

First, for all of this to work, both him and I need to take some time out of our day: me having to run 20 minutes (on net, it just acts as an incentive to go for a run, but still); he, having to get off the tube during the morning commute to do a monetary drug deal.

Second, since he never knows when and where he's gonna be able to land a trade like this, he must carry cash well above his own needs to be able to trade on a moment's notice. And I could tell: he carried thousands of extra CZK cash, ready to be stolen or expropriated or asked odd questions by police officers if found out. From a regular economics point of view, his opportunity cost is the interest he could have earned on that... or in a Bitcoin world, the opportunity cost of bitcoin increasing in value. Basically, for the trade to work and there be enough liquidity in the (local) market, **a bunch of Bitcoiners need to hold a bunch extra fiat just to hand them over to other Bitcoiners**. Structurally quite bad.

Third, the transaction costs were *awful*. First, it cost me some 2% in the wallet miscalculating/diverging from market prices... didn't stress it, just wanted to try this thing for a small amount. Then Lightning tx fees, and then almost 3% in the BTC/USD (well, CZK, but amounts to the same thing) . . <>

continued misbehaving in the process, i.e., between us agreeing to the trade the night before and realizing it the next morning, price had moved that much against me. (Fucking pathetic bitcoin, but whatever.)

= in expectation, this is as likely to go in the other direction, so economically speaking and over time this ought not be considered much of a cost – other than short-term annoyance and uncertainty. (Plus, my loss is his gain, so whatever).

The kicker? We made this trade at \$109,000 or something, the price having bounced from 107k... and then collapsed to the loser levels of the 80s and 70s we've been in. So technically speaking, my fiat held its value *AMAZINGLY* compared to this rubbish orange dream.

Second kicker to potentially justify the entire ordeal? I didn't use all of those CZK, had about 1,000 left when I traveled to family in Sweden. In this digital society, one does not use much cash – certainly not of a Czech calibre. Easy, I thought, I'd just go to a local currency-exchange and be expropriated on the rate but at least I'll get some non-KYC cash here, no?

Wrong.

First, they fucked me about 6% on the FX spread. Second, they charged a \$6 "admin fee," eating up even more of the tiny leftover cash I had. Third, *lady required me to insert my driver's license in a machine to identify myself.*

Why, I asked? It's only a pittance of money

"YES!" she aggressively retorted, "we're operating under money laundering laws, and we gotta make sure we know who's exchanging money!" I looked at her puzzled, glanced down at the fifty bucks' worth of fiat between us and wondered however this small amount could fit into that "YES," she said, noticeably annoyed, "otherwise people can just hit all of our offices and illegally transfer money everywhere!"

Just wow

Also, everything that's wrong with the state of economics and the state and ideological/cultural convictions is contained in that phrase, "illegally transfer money." What the fuck do you think money is, what the hell is your understanding of "illegal"? All the transaction costs, price costs, opportunity costs and other inefficiencies involved in peer-to-peer are worth it RIGHT THERE. The laws governing this lady's job, the fact that she has a job at all, and the scammy infrastructure that enables (read: parasitising) on money exchange altogether, are so evil and dumb and regressive that it's worth lots of inconvenience to get around it. Fuck me.

Peer-to-peer is totally a thing, economically efficient or not

Meme Monday - Top Meme Goes in the Newsletter

top meme

362 sats \ 11 comments \ @sn 5 Jan

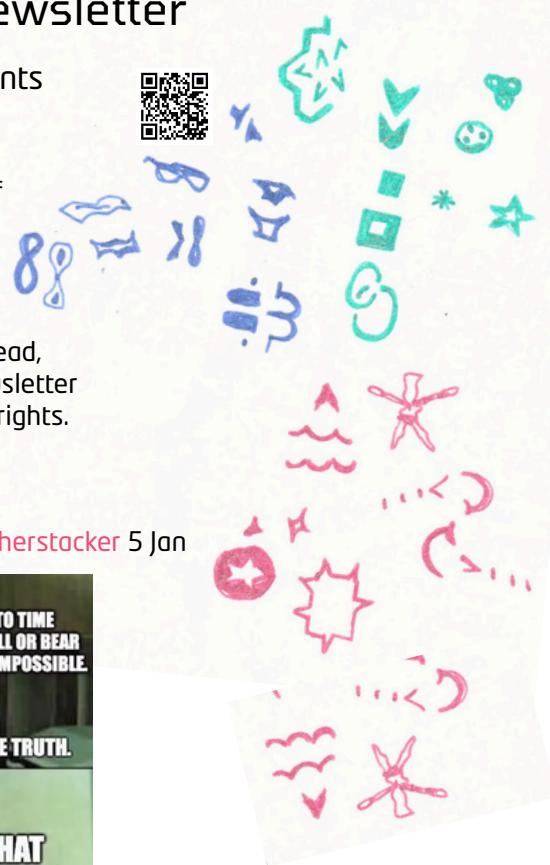


Time for another round of Meme Monday!

The week's winner, as determined by the "top" filter on this thread, will go in this week's newsletter and get eternal bragging rights.

Send your best 👉

78 sats \ 0 replies \ @hasherstacker 5 Jan



51 sats \ 0 replies \ @Scoresby 5 Jan



top
post

Jet Lag, Wine, and Pope Paul VI

2853 sats \ 21 comments \ @siggy47

siggy
saga



7 Jan the_stack_muse BooksAndArticles

When I was

fifteen years old

I took a trip to Rome sponsored by the Catholic High School I attended. Around fifteen students were chaperoned by a teaching brother of the order that ran our school. We would visit the Vatican and attend a public mass served by Pope Paul VI in Saint Peter's Square.

The mass was scheduled for the day after our flight landed in Rome. I recall being tired, having not accounted for the effects of jet lag. It was also a very hot, humid day. This mass was a very big deal for the members of the religious order who led our group. There was excitement in the air. We walked from our inexpensive Catholic pilgrim lodging to a small restaurant to get some lunch before heading over to St. Peter's. The restaurant could not accommodate our entire party at one table, so another kid and I were assigned to a separate table. We all were given food allowances before the trip began, so we had money.

The waiter came to our table and placed a carafe of red wine down before we had said a word. We looked at each other. We were two American teenagers, never having been given sensible guidance about a healthy relationship to alcohol, so we took full advantage of the opportunity.

We downed the wine far too quickly, then ordered a second carafe. Then another. It was a very enjoyable meal, as I recall. We finished off bottle number three just as we spotted the rest of the group get up to leave the restaurant. We settled our bill and followed them.

As we exited the door I tried to keep my eyes on our group, but it was difficult because of the dense crowd of people on the street walking towards Saint Peter's. The other kid saw the group and pushed ahead. I was a bit drunk and tired, and I walked smack into a street light pole, which snapped my eyeglasses in two. The other kid had not seen my mishap. I should mention that I was born with a severe astigmatism in my left eye, and my right eye isn't great either, so I didn't get around too well without glasses. I realized that I was now on my own.

Even in my impaired state it was easy to follow the crowd to St. Peter's Square. It wasn't far, and it seemed as if everyone on the continent was heading in that direction. I was surrounded. There was very little space for me to walk without colliding with another person. Soon the group I was a part of was absorbed into the sea that filled the square. We had arrived.

I was drunk and tired. I wasn't really looking forward to standing through the entire Catholic liturgy. I looked around for a place to sit down. No chance. I knew I wouldn't find my group either.

There was a murmur in the crowd. A surge of people pressed closely against me. I didn't know what was going on. Using my limited knowledge of the Italian language, I deduced that Pope Paul VI had arrived in the square. I just wanted to go to sleep. Soon the space between me and the other people closed, and I was lifted off my feet by the wall of bodies. I was soaked in my own sweat and that of the pilgrims around me. The stench of body odor was overwhelming. People were screaming "Il papa." I wanted to be anywhere but there. I blaspheme, but Rome in July is hot as hell.

At this point I experienced a miracle. There is no other way to explain it. The crowd parted to get around the base of a light pole. I was pushed into the cool stone, and slid down into a sitting position. It was the perfect refuge. People passed close by me, but never touched me. I put my head down and fell asleep. I awoke later in the afternoon to see that the mass was over.

I had not seen the Pope nor heard him speak. Most of the crowd was gone. Tourists gathered in small groups, and workers swept up debris. I climbed to my feet and found my way back to the dormitory. My eyeglasses were held together with tape for the rest of the trip.



top
comment

90 sats \ 0 replies \
@Oxbitcoiner 7 Jan

Normally a miracle means seeing something supernatural. In your case, it was the opposite, you saw nothing. God turned water into wine, you turn wine into a nap! hahaha.

